Gerlinde **Theunissen**

gtheunissen@ethz.ch | https://gerlindetheunissen.github.io/ | https://github.com/gerlindetheunissen

Working Experience

DBAUG, ETH *Zurich, Switzerland*

POSTDOCTORAL RESEARCHER | SPUR *2026 — ongoing*

Research on spatial developments and housing.

Sotomo, Zürich *Zürich, Switzerland*

PROJECT MANAGEMENT & DATA SCIENCE *2025 — ongoing*

- Applied quantitative socio-spatial research on socio-demographic and spatial developments in Switzerland using linked Swiss registry data (STATPOP, GWS, GWR, Strukturerhebung).
- Producing maps, dashboards, visualizations, and structured reports for public authorities, media, and research partners.
- Communicating findings to broad audiences, including TV and print media, panels, and round tables.
- Planning and coordinating multiple research projects with public administrations, municipalities, and NGOs.
- Managing team deadlines and resources.

CIDOB (Barcelona Centre for International Affairs) *Barcelona, Spain*

RESEARCH INTERN | 'GLOBAL CITIES' *Mar. 2020 — Jul. 2020*

Policy briefs on Covid-19 urban policies for the municipality of Barcelona.

Oxfam Novib *The Hague, Netherlands*

RESEARCH INTERN | 'GOVERNANCE AND FINANCIAL FLOWS' *Nov. 2018 — May 2019*

Research on international taxation with a focus on gender biases and non-OECD countries.

German Embassy *Sofia, Bulgaria*

INTERN *Aug. 2016 — Oct. 2016*

Reports, presentations, speeches on corruption and emigration trends.

WeMove.eu *Lübeck / Remote, Germany*

ASSISTANT | GERMAN CAMPAIGN TEAM *2016 — 2018*

Public communication (website/ social networks / email); organization of online and offline campaigns.

Academic Working Experience

Cluster of Excellence 'The Politics of Inequality', University of Konstanz *Konstanz, Germany*

INDEPENDENT DOCTORAL RESEARCHER *Oct. 2020 — Sep. 2024*

- Research on urban inequality, neighborhood dynamics, and political behavior in the Global South.
- Collecting, managing, and analyzing large heterogeneous spatial datasets incl. satellite imagery, administrative records, street network data, and georeferenced survey data.
- Publishing in academic journals and presenting findings at international conferences.

Institute for Political Science Zurich, University of Zurich *Zurich, Switzerland*

GUEST RESEARCHER *Jan. 2024 — Sep. 2024*

Center for Comparative Immigration Studies, University of California, San Diego *San Diego, CA, USA*

GUEST RESEARCHER *Sep. 2023 — Dec. 2023*

Education

Graduate School of Behavioural Science (GSBS) | University of Konstanz *Konstanz, Germany*

DOCTOR OF SOCIAL SCIENCE *2020 — Dec. 2024*

Dissertation: *Close Comparisons: How Local Exposure to Inequality Shapes Perceptions and Political Behavior*

Committee: Nils B. Weidmann, Anke Hoeffler, Claire Adida

Erasmus Mundus joint program | International Institute of Social Studies (ISS) at Erasmus University Rotterdam, Institut Barcelona d'Estudis Internacionals (IBEI) at Pompeu Fabra University *The Hague (NL), Barcelona (ES)*

MASTER IN PUBLIC POLICY, POLITICAL ECONOMY AND DEVELOPMENT *2018 — 2020*

University of Konstanz *Konstanz, Germany*

BACHELOR IN POLITICS AND PUBLIC ADMINISTRATION *2014 — 2018*

Research

PUBLISHED

Weidmann, Nils B., and Theunissen, Gerlinde. 2021. "Estimating Local Inequality from Nighttime Lights." *Remote Sensing* 13, no. 22: 4624. https://doi.org/10.3390/rs13224624.
Replication data at GESIS: https://doi.org/10.7802/2345.

Theunissen, Gerlinde and Weidmann, Nils B. "All Social Comparisons are Local? Inequality, Coethnicity, and Subjective Economic Position." *Swiss Political Science Review*, 32, 156–176. https://doi.org/10.1111/spsr.70022

IN PREPARATION

Theunissen, Gerlinde and Keremoğlu, Eda. "Status Updates — Does Internet Exposure Make People Feel Poorer?"

Theunissen, Gerlinde. "The (Dis-)Empowering Paths of Comparisons — Neighborhood Exposure to Inequality and Voter Turnout." (Preprint available at SSRN: https://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.5048622)

TALKS

3rd July 2024. *Pre-EPSA Workshop "Multi-Data Perspectives on Democracy"*. GESIS, Cologne.

25th April 2024. *Pre-Publication Seminar*. IPZ, University of Zürich.

17th October 2023. *Political Economy Lunch Group (PELG) Speaker Series*. UCSD.

29–30th September 2022. *Empirical Peace and Conflict Research Workshop of the German Association for Peace and Conflict Studies (AFK)*. Sandbjerg (DK).

24th May 2022. *Comparative Politics Speaker Series and InFER Colloquium*. Goethe University Frankfurt (with Nils B. Weidmann).

5th May 2022. *"Transformations of Democracy" Colloquium at WZB*. Berlin (with Nils B. Weidmann).

6–8th April 2022. *Inequality Conference of the Cluster of Excellence 'The Politics of Inequality'*. Konstanz.

17–19th March 2022. *53rd Annual Conference of the German Association for Peace and Conflict Studies (AFK)*. Konstanz.

7–8th December 2021. *World Inequality Conference of the World Inequality Lab*. Paris School of Economics (with Nils B. Weidmann).

SUMMER SCHOOLS

September 2024. *Athens Natural Language Processing Summer School (AthNLP)*. NCSR Demokritos, Athens.

September 2023. *Advanced Scientific Programming in Python (ASPP)*. Institute of Molecular Biology and Biotechnology, Heraklion.

July 2023. *Women in Political Methodology*. University of Basel.

Outside Academic Projects and Public Engagement

SELECTION OF APPLIED RESEARCH AND MEDIA WORK

Gemeindeberichte - Schweizer Gemeinde Verband | Sotomo, current. Automated analysis of registry data for municipalities.

Wohnraum für Zürich und die Schweiz | Fürschi Züri - Sotomo, 2026. Quantitative analysis of population dynamics, housing qualities and evictions in Zurich compared to other Swiss cities.

Wohnreport Schweiz - Best Ager in Bewegung | Helvetia - Sotomo, 2026. Quantitative analysis of residential mobility patterns among households aged 55–74 in Switzerland. Covered by NZZ am Sonntag and Tagesschau.

Wohnraumanalyse Kreuzlingen | Sotomo, 2025.

COMMUNITY AND KNOWLEDGE EXCHANGE

Co-organizer, R-Users Zurich Meet-ups | 2024 — ongoing. Organisation of regular community events for R users in Zürich, including speaker coordination, venue management, and knowledge-sharing sessions.

Scholarships and Funding

2023. *Outgoing Fellowship* | *Cluster of Excellence "The Politics of Inequality".*

2023. *Konstanzia MEiN* | *University of Konstanz.*

2018 — 2020. *Full scholarship for the Erasmus Mundus Joint Master Degree (EMJMD)* | *Erasmus+ Programme of the European Union.*

2016 — 2020. *German Academic Scholarship Foundation* | *Studienstiftung des Deutschen Volkes.*

Skills

Languages German, English, Dutch, Spanish *(full professional proficiency)* | Danish, French *(advanced)* | Bulgarian *(basic understanding)* | Swiss German, Italian *(passive understanding)*.

Tools Python, R, (Postgres) SQL, Git, Github, LaTeX, Markdown, HTML, QGIS, Javascript, Microsoft Office.

Methods Statistical analysis and causal inference; spatial, time-series, and survey data; machine learning and predictive modelling; computational text and image analysis; data management and visualization; web applications and dashboards; research design; policy and project evaluation.

References

1. Advisor: Nils B. Weidmann
University of Konstanz
nils.weidmann@uni-konstanz.de

2. Advisor: Anke Hoeffler
University of Konstanz
anke.hoeffler@uni-konstanz.de

External Advisor: Claire Adida
University of California, San Diego
cadida@ucsd.edu

MEiN Mentor: Christina Schneider
University of California, San Diego
cjschneider@ucsd.edu